AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Faculty of Business Studies

BUS310 - Strategic Management: Creating Competitive Advantages

Mid-term Examination

2025-2026/Fall
15-November-2025

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Number of Exam Pages:2 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

Instructions:

ALL QUESTIONS ARE COMPULSORY

- This examination consists of **Three (3) questions**. Answer **All Three** questions.
- The marks for each part of the question are next to the question.
- The MTA is worth **30 %** of the total course assessment.
- Use the Answer Booklet provided to you to answer the questions, and do not forget to wri your name, student number and section number in the specified space on the cover of the Answer Booklet.
- Write in black or blue ink only.
- Do not remove this question paper from the examination room unless the invigilator has gi you permission to do so.
- You are expected to refer to course materials, provide critical analysis, and use diagra illustrations, and practical examples from your own experience, where applicable.
- At the end of the examination, candidates must remain seated until the invigilators have collected and checked all the Answer Booklets.
- Any form of cheating will NOT be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.
- You should keep the organization of the exam paper neat, use good English, and write clearly using good handwriting.

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Answer All the following questions:

Question One (35 Marks)

Strategic management consists of three ongoing processes/activities that organizations undertake in order to create and sustain competitive advantages.

A. Give a brief description of strategic management (10 marks)
B. Briefly explain the strategic management implementation key concept (10marks).
C. Briefly explain five different activities that organizations undertake when implementing their strategies. (15marks)

Question Two (30 Marks)

Briefly describe unrelated diversification strategy (8 marks). Explain the benefits and five related guidelines that reveal when **unrelated diversification** may be an effective strategy to follow (20 marks). Support your answer with relevant examples (2 marks)

Question Three (35 Marks)

Michael Porter advocated various forces of competition in an industry to determine the intensity of competition and the level of profitability in a business environment. Explain the bargaining power of buyers' competitive force (5 marks) and discuss five reasons when bargaining buyers power increases (25 marks). Support your answer with examples (5 marks)

End of questions

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